

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

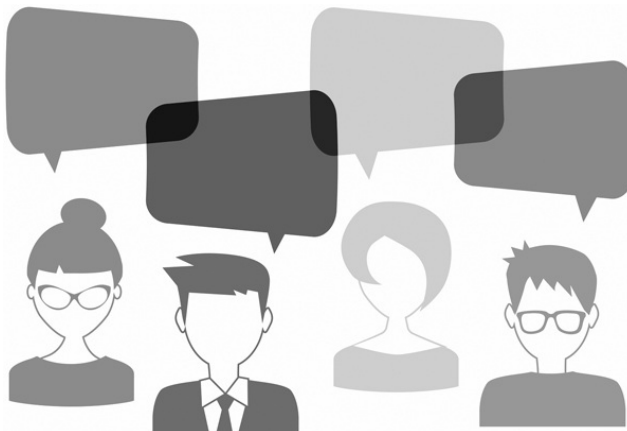
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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: What a misunderstanding!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about what needs to be done or needs doing.
- I can deal with communication breakdowns.
- I can talk about my work responsibilities.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever experienced a communication breakdown or misunderstanding over the phone? What happened?
- What can you do to make sure that you understand someone clearly when you are talking on the phone?





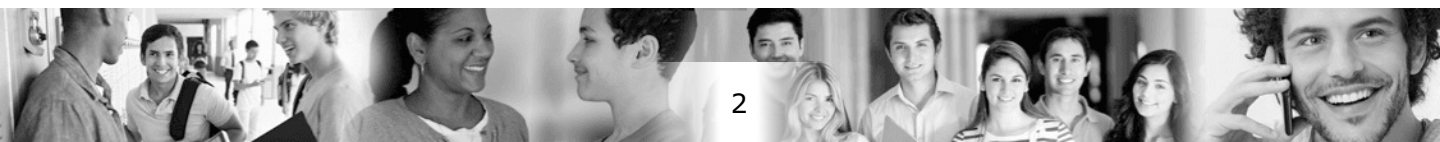
Let's Explore!

Adam gets a bit **flustered*** on the phone!

* "Flustered" means nervous and confused.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Fiona: Thompson Paper Products. How can I help you?
Adam: Hi. My name is Adam Bari. I'm calling from BFP. I have an order that needs placing please.
Fiona: Great. What would you like?
Adam: Ummm. Let's see ...
Fiona: You need C?
Adam: No. Sorry. Let me start again. I need B grade ...
Fiona: Greyed? Dark or light?
Adam: No, not G - R - E - Y - E - D ... G - R - A - D - E ... B grade.
Fiona: Oh. I'm having trouble hearing you. There's a lot of background noise. The music needs to be turned down.
Adam: There's nothing I can do about it. It's not my music. It's the other copy editors' and they're not there.
Fiona: Excuse me, but that's no excuse. Turn it down.
Adam: Can you repeat that please?
Fiona: The background noise needs to be reduced. And can you please speak a little slower?
Adam: I need B grade, white, 8 and a half by 11.
Fiona: Wait a minute, that's a minute size. Are you sure about that? That's not the usual size.
Adam: Ummm, Let me find the form. Oh, sorry, 85 by 110.
Fiona: Do you want the whole order?
Adam: Holes? No I don't think so. Without holes.
Fiona: I meant whole, as in entire.
Adam: Oh. Right. I didn't write it down. Ummm, okay yeah the whole order. I think that's what I need.
Fiona: This order needs confirming before you place it. Are you certain you need to order the whole amount?
Adam: Ummm. Yeah. It's confirmed. That's what I wrote on the form.
Fiona: Okay, so. Let me read back to you. B grade, white, 85 by 110, the whole order.
Adam: That's correct.
Fiona: Okay, your account needs updating. Can I go ahead and add this transaction?
Adam: Yes, thank you.
Fiona: Thank you for your order. Have a great day.





Let's Practice!

Adam arranges an order with the supplier.

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

needs confirming before / needs to be reduced / needing to order / needs placing /
needs to be turned down / need to order / needs to encounter

1. I have an order that _____ please.
2. The music _____.
3. The background noise _____.
4. The date of this order _____ you deliver it.
5. Are you certain you _____ the whole amount?



Let's Practice!

The words sound the same to Adam.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Circle the incorrect word. Write the correction on top of the incorrect word.

1. Are you certain you filed out the form?
2. Do you want the enter order?
3. I have confirming what I wrote on the form.
4. Let me read that black to you.
5. Okay, your accountant needs updating.
6. Can I go head and add this transiction?
7. There is a lot of backward noise. Can you speak louder?





Extension Activity

Make a list of homonyms.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, brainstorm as many homonyms that you know without using the Internet.
- Write all your homonym pairs down on a piece of paper.
- On your own, write a dialogue or a story and use as many pairs of homonyms from your list as you can.
- Read your story or dialogue to your partner. Who used the most homonyms?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I brainstorm homonyms.

☐ ☐

I write a list of homonyms.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue or story using my list of homonyms.

☐ ☐

I read my story or dialogue to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to place an order** (expression): to arrange to order something
e.g. I have an order that needs placing please.
- grade** (noun): a level of quality
e.g. I need B grade.
- entire** (adjective): whole; complete
e.g. Do you want the entire order?
- certain** (adjective): sure
e.g. Are you certain you need to order the whole amount?
- background noise** (noun): noise that can be heard behind other sounds that are louder
e.g. The background noise needs to be reduced.
- minute** (adjective): very, very small
e.g. That's a minute size.





Learning Points

Homonyms

Homonyms are made up of homophones and homographs.

A **homophone** is a word that has the same sound as another word but has a different meaning and may have a different spelling.

For example:

right and *write*

right (noun) and *right* (adjective)

A **homograph** is a word that has the same spelling as another word but has a different sound and a different meaning.

For example:

present (noun) and *present* (verb)

wind (noun) and *wind* (verb)

Examples:

- *Ummm. Let's **see** ... You need **C**?*
- *It's the other copy editors', and **they're** not **there**.*
- ***Excuse** me, but that's no **excuse**.*
- *Do you want the **whole** order? Without **holes**.*
- *Oh. **Right**. I didn't **write** it down.*
- *Wait a **minute**, that's a **minute** size.*

Tips for Making a Purchase Over the Phone

Talking on the phone in English can be challenging at times. There are certain strategies that you can use to make yourself understood and to better understand another person.

When you make a purchase over the phone, it is important to be clear. There are things that can be miscommunicated such as: your name, telephone number, credit card information, date of birth, etc. It is a good idea to prepare these things ahead of time and practice saying them loudly, slowly and clearly.

Here are some phrases that can help you communicate better over the phone:

Let me start again.

I'm having trouble hearing you.

Can you repeat that please?

And can you please speak a little slower?

No, not G-R-E-Y-E-D ... G-R-A-D-E. (spell words)

